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Dear Prof. Sobel,

We are pleased to submit a second revision of the manuscript *Young Children's Spontaneous Comprehension of Symbol-Referent Relationships in the Graphic Domain* (CD MS CHILDDEV-2025-1273) due on September 10th, 2026, for publication as an empirical article in *Child Development*. We are thankful for the concise and constructive feedback we have received and have amended the manuscript accordingly. As before, we provide a detailed overview in the responses, a track-change version and a clean version of the manuscript.

In short, we have restructured the manuscript, omitted the *General Methods* section and cut redundancy in methods and discussion, shortening the manuscript by about 1200 words in total. We have reworked the presentation of the illustrations. We have taken the methodological critique seriously and now consistently point the reader to limitations in precision of our estimates. The terminology for describing our stimuli (iconic / abstract) has been simplified and is now introduced specifically in the introduction. We also have double-checked the manuscript again for minor inconsistencies or errors.

As before, the manuscript complies with the SRCD sociocultural policy. Relevant information regarding data collection and sample characteristics can be found in the methods section of study 1 (page 9).

We would like to thank the reviewers for their thoughtful and constructive feedback!

Sincerely,



Gregor Kachel (PhD)

Date 14.07.2026